

ALEX RIVERA

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BIO

Software engineer with five years of experience building backend services and the product features on top of them. Comfortable owning a feature from API design through frontend delivery, with a track record of improving reliability and performance along the way.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer, Northwind Analytics, Platform team, Chicago, IL 03/2023–Present

- Redesigned the ingestion service behind customer dashboards, moving from batch polling to a streaming pipeline (Kafka, Go) and cutting data freshness from 15 minutes to under 30 seconds at 20K events/sec.
- Cut p99 API latency 60% by profiling hot paths, adding query-level caching, and rewriting the database access patterns of the two worst-offending endpoints.

Tech Stack: Go, TypeScript, Kafka, Postgres, Redis, Kubernetes, Grafana

Software Engineer, Lakeshore Labs, Chicago, IL 07/2020–03/2023

- Shipped the customer-facing usage-analytics feature end to end (React, TypeScript, Node.js), which became a top-three driver of enterprise renewals.
- Led the migration from a legacy cron-based monolith to containerized workers on Kubernetes, cutting deploy time from 45 minutes to 5 and enabling per-service scaling.
- Interviewed and onboarded engineers as the team grew from 4 to 11.

Tech Stack: TypeScript, Node.js, React, Postgres, Docker, Kubernetes

Software Engineering Intern, Harborview Systems, Seattle, WA 06/2019–09/2019

- Built an indexed log-search web tool for the support team, replacing grep-over-SSH and cutting median ticket investigation time by half.
- Shipped to production before the internship ended; received and accepted a return offer for a final-year part-time role.

Tech Stack: Python, Elasticsearch, Flask

EDUCATION

BS in Computer Science, State University 2020

- Undergraduate research in the Data Systems Lab; teaching assistant for the databases course.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Systems & Infrastructure: Kafka; Kubernetes; Redis; gRPC; Observability (Prometheus, Grafana); Performance & Load Testing; CI/CD; Incident Response & On-Call

Product & Web: React; TypeScript; Node.js; REST & GraphQL API Design; Instrumentation & Feature-Flag Rollouts

Languages: Go, TypeScript, Python, SQL, C++